13.8 Summary

- Converting an internal application into a multi-tenant service requires rethinking authorization boundaries and data isolation.
- A layered authorization model—system, application, and tenant—clarifies ownership and separates trust domains.
- A consistent identity and tenancy foundation supports policy evaluation across both federated and hosted tenants.
- Requests pass through global and tenant PEP/PDP pairs, following the PARC model from enforcement to decision.
- Policy enforcement points can operate at different levels—gateway, service, and UI—each enhancing security and usability.
- The UI leverages graph traversal, partial evaluation, and batch PDP checks to efficiently address visibility questions.
- A layered policy architecture and template system enables tenants to customize collaboration securely within shared constraints.
- ACME’s internal case studies show the effectiveness of layered authorization in real-world operations.
- An integration checklist now guides new systems joining ACME’s policy engine architecture.